

Sultans of Swing -- Dire Straits

Dire Straits, 1978. ~148 BPM.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

John Illsley's part is a clean, moving fingerstyle line with walking passing tones between chord changes and a steady, driving eighth-note feel under Knopfler's fingerpicked Strat.

It's a late-70s, pre-gloss tone: dry, woody, and even. It has to leave the mids open for the guitar.

AMP: Foxy Bass (Vox AC-100) + CAB: TC410 IR (User IR 9)

Foxy Bass is a simple Bass/Treble voicing. It doesn't draw attention to itself, which fits this record's direct, unhyped sound.

TC410 is flat with a mild 100Hz bump, so it's a neutral cab that won't color the part.

- VOL: 66, Bass: 55, Treble: 55. Balanced. No tricks.
- CAB VOL: 60.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 12. Light. Clean tone, not much noise.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 50.

A clean level push for the long outro solo. The band gets louder, and the bass has to keep up without changing character.

DST -- off. Clean the whole way.

AMP -- Foxy Bass, always on. VOL 66, Bass 55, Treble 55.

CAB -- User IR 9 (TC410), always on. VOL 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +1, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: 0, 800Hz: +2, 4.5kHz: +1, VOL: 55.

120Hz gives the notes body. 800Hz makes the walking passing tones readable.

The top stays close to flat so it sounds woody, not zingy.

MOD -- off. This is the 1978 record, not Brothers in Arms. No chorus sheen.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 15, Decay: 25, Trail: on.

A bit of air for the solo sections.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off**: verses and choruses. Dry, even, clean, and locked with the hi-hat. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on**: mid-song solo and the extended outro solo. Clean boost plus room to match the band's push.

Engage when Knopfler takes a solo. Back off at the next verse.